

OE3C Planning Meeting 13 Contents

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OE3C Planning Meeting 13

Meeting Details and Recording Link

Date: 02 Apr 2026

Location: CRN412/Online

Time: 11:02 AM – 12:35 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Matthew Summerville, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Katherine Yagi, Nicholas Benton, Harry Kumbhani, Madelaine Legault, Paige Au

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time Thursday, April 02 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Important Notes from Meeting

Post-meeting items for review

- **Photo Contest**
 - o Suggestion to invite the Brock photography club to participate in the contest
- **Outings**
 - o Ideas to use badges, a list, and wristbands to track people on the bus to/from Niagara Falls
- **Hybrid OE3C Options**
 - o Pending discussion about uploading virtual OE3C talks after the conference ends (for people that were unable to attend in-person)
- **Banquet Entertainment and Layout**
 - o Pending discussion about DIY photo booth ideas, in case we do not pay for a photo booth (some companies are unavailable or do not provide physical copies)
 - o Cassia is drafting a new layout of the banquet area to include more details of all aspects of the banquet (entertainment, displays, bar, etc.)

Notes for all LOC members

- Registration deadline has been extended to April 10th
- Send any honorarium gift ideas for the Elder speaker to Madelaine
- Please submit a photo to the photo contest website!
- Send recommendations for the photo contest prize packages or People's Choice Award to Madelaine
- Regarding posts/flyers: please use the Canva business account (contact Alex for an invite link)
- Send any recommendations for the Best Botany Talk judge to Alex (judging must be in-person) and any ideas for a gift we can give to the judge(s)

Links from meeting

- <https://hamiltonsofpelham.com/>
 - o Website for the "Hamiltons of Pelham" store to browse potential gifts for the Elder speaker
- [@brockphotoclub](#)
 - o Instagram handle for the Brock Photography Club
- [@golfindigo](#)
 - o Instagram handle for Alex's brother's mini golf page

Meeting Minutes

Call to Order

- Alex started the meeting at 11:02 AM

Registration

- **Deadline has been extended to April 10th**
- CSEE dates are interfering with registrants (people are unable to attend OE3C and CSEE due to costs and how close the conferences are)
- We have 27 people registered so far, not including LOC members
 - o 15 people have registered for the banquet
 - o 2 people have registered for the CCOVI event
 - o 9 shirts were ordered

Room Bookings

- From Kiyoko:
 - o Requested room for volunteer training on Apr 29th
 - o Need to confirm the banquet layout for Market Hall
 - Cassia will be drafting a new layout – there was a general discussion near the end of the meeting to confirm placement options for entertainment, the dance floor, dinner seating, and the bar
 - o Need to confirm the Pond Inlet layout and A/V equipment
 - Kiyoko might use the same layout used for the GRAMSS FMS GRaD conference (includes welcome tables, tables for food and sponsors) – we agreed to this layout

Workshops and Outings Update

- From Madelaine:
 - o Met with Syerra at the Hadiya'dagenhahs office to discuss hosting an Elder guest to speak at OE3C
 - Syerra will work with us as a liaison to organise a speaker
 - She suggested for the Elder to speak at both the opening and closing ceremony
 - The Elder should be offered food first at any meals
 - o Alex confirmed that this can be done for the banquet, but they are unsure if we can uphold offering the Elder food first during coffee breaks because the refreshments/food will be setup already
 - Madelaine will ask Syerra for clarification

- Expenses for Elder speaker:
 - Travel expenses would mainly include a parking pass
 - Cultural gifts – tobacco, blanket, beaded earrings, Madelaine has a blade of sweetgrass to include
 - Madelaine needs to know budget for honorarium and travel expenses
 - Kiyoko confirmed that we can allocate \$250 – this is funding left over from the Exchange grant after covering the keynote speakers' expenses
 - We do not object to this amount
 - **Madelaine asked the LOC to send her any gift ideas**
 - Wylan can bring herbs to add to the gift
 - Alex is working on a blanket that can go towards the gift
 - She also suggested browsing the Hamiltons of Pelham store
- Photo contest update
 - Still no submissions
 - **Madelaine asked LOC members to please participate in the contest**
 - Katherine suggested posting about the contest or posting a reel/video talking about it so people know the platform is up
 - Nick confirmed that the photo contest will be included in the abstract submission form
 - Wylan confirmed that the QR code to access website is not working (*07 April: this issue might be resolved now - Lyly*)
 - Alex suggested inviting the Brock photography club to participate (@brockphotoclub)
 - Prize packs for contest
 - Madelaine is reaching out to local businesses
 - Provisions Food Company donated jam
 - Currently putting together gift baskets
 - Made some seed balls for native pollinator plants
 - **LOC was advised to send recommendations for the prize packages**
 - Wylan offered to add custom made keychains
 - Katherine offered prizes through 8Trees

- Nick is also interested in these prizes for the workshops (e.g., the Computer Science workshop)
 - **Madelaine is also looking for a special prize for a People's Choice award**
 - Alex suggested reaching out to camera stores (e.g., Frederick's, Henry's)
 - Confirmed that Alex Popescu is modelling a 3D printed version of the OE3C badger which could be used for the award
 - Kiyoko will ask for book donations from their colleagues
 - Pocket Guide to Scientific Writing; Feminism in the Wild
 - Kiyoko suggested advertising the prize packages, which Madelaine is currently planning already
- From Wylan:
 - Will send out the synopsis of the hikes soon
 - Working on scripts, hike stops, etc.
- From Nick:
 - Finalising the promotion posters for the workshops
 - Wylan and Alex offered to help with this
 - Working on the prizes for the coding workshop
 - Art gallery update:
 - Matt made a social media post to call for artists
 - **Reminder from Alex regarding posts/flyers: please use the business team Canva account**
 - No updates on the panel yet (will be held on May 1st in the afternoon)
 - Need to confirm who will be invited
 - Alex, Nick, Wylan will be meeting to discuss further
- From Alex:
 - Bus to Niagara Falls (Clifton Hill) has been booked and paid for
 - **Discussion on how we will track people getting on the bus**
 - Kiyoko suggested using badges
 - **Do we want a backup plan in case people lose their badges?**
 - Sarah suggested keeping a list
 - Reem suggested getting wristbands

Merch Update

- Notebook covers
 - o Paige and Kiyoko will work on purchasing the notebooks, pens, and stickers soon
- Tote bags
 - o Lauren contacted Mat and received a quote
 - Kiyoko asked to be kept on emails regarding payments for the bags
- Lanyards
 - o Sarah will order the lanyards on Amazon soon; Kiyoko will help pay for them
 - o Reem asked about nametag printing
 - They have a spreadsheet with all the registrant names
 - Alex confirmed that we will use our own printers (saves costs)
 - There will be a meeting to organise nametags after registration closes
- Shirts
 - o Deadline to order: Apr 10th

Banquet Update

- Cassia was exploring options for other photo booth companies
 - o Option A is digital photo booth only – not going with this option
 - o Option B provides digital and physical photocopies
 - Cassia confirmed that this company will not be available for the conference (we will look for an alternative option, like a DIY photo booth)

Abstracts Update

- Nick confirmed that there have been 30 abstract submissions so far
 - o Has a checklist and review tips for abstract reviewers
 - o Some abstracts were uploaded before we announced the Botany journal award
 - Nick is working on an email to reach out to people that already submitted a botany-related abstract and confirm if they want to be considered for this award

Volunteer Update

- Alex sent another email to Heather to distribute the call for volunteers
 - o The call will also go out to Con-Ed and Applied Health students
 - o Deadline to apply was April 6th
 - T-shirt sizes for volunteers will be known by Apr 7th

- Volunteers will go through training with Alex
 - In-person on Apr 29th and with a video recording
 - HRE has provided some information that will be included in the training to satisfy the insurance requirements
- Madelaine is approved to bring their nephew who wants to help

Guest Author Appearances

- Katherine will show her books and books from 8Trees
 - Needs to know when they will be there
 - Alex confirmed that they can organise a day and time based on what ever works best for Kat
- Mark Zelinski worked on a book about Niagara – no charges for their appearance
 - Will have a table at the banquet and will be given a small time slot to speak about their book
- Nick asked about having authors at the panel
 - Alex confirmed that she asked Mark, but he will not be available to attend the panel

Open Discussion

- Judge for the Best Botany Talk
 - Alex thought about inviting Kasia to judge
 - Kasia did their MSc at Brock in Liette Vasseur's lab
 - No objections
 - **LOC was advised to send ideas about a gift we can give to the judge**
 - Alex also thought about Heather as an alternative option, but not sure if Heather has the capacity
 - Heather is an undergrad academic advisor in FMS who also did their MSc in Liette's lab
 - **LOC was asked to send any recommendations for judges (needs to be in-person) and send ideas about a gift we can give to the judge(s)**
- Making the conference hybrid
 - Someone asked Alex if this can be an option
 - Alex thought we could make a link available if they make a small donation to OE3C
 - Or have the talks uploaded as a virtual conference after OE3C
 - **We are tabling this discussion for later**

- Banquet layout and photo booth
 - Photo booth company Cassia liked will not be available
 - We might consider an alternative option – we might be able to bring in a camera and have a printer
 - **We are tabling the photo booth discussion**
 - Cassia is interested in possibly collaborating with the Brock library for seeds with seed paper
 - Madelaine confirmed that they do not have seed paper, but they can probably donate the seeds
 - Banquet layout
 - Entertainment – includes the photo booth, dance area, and potentially mini golf
 - Alex will confirm the costs for mini golf (@golfindigo)
 - Kat asked who will be the emcee?
 - Cassia is okay with doing it, she might work with Kaitlyn (undergrad from Alex's lab)
 - Lyly offered to be a backup option if Kaitlyn is unavailable
 - Cassia will redo the banquet layout to include:
 - Art display
 - Mini golf
 - Dancing area
 - Bar instead of a food buffet (we are having a plated dinner)
 - TV display for the photo contest
 - Stage
 - Dining area
 - Check-in

Meeting adjourned at 12:35 pm.

Appended Notes

From Madelaine:

Indigenous Elder Guest Speaker

- Met with Syerra at Hadiya'dagenhahs on Tuesday to discuss collaboration with OE3C, presented the idea of hosting an Elder as an honoured guest who would speak at the opening ceremony on 04/30
- Syerra offered support in coordinating this planning and acting as a liaison between OE3C and an Elder, and provided helpful reminders about cultural protocols with regards to asking for an Elder's attendance and offering gifts
- Syerra recommended Grandmother Jackie Labonte of the Haudenosaunee Turtle Clan, who is of these lands and can speak to ecology, the environment, and kinship, which is well-suited to our theme for this year
 - As a back up option in case Grandmother Jackie is not available, Syerra recommended Sherri Vansickle, who teaches at Brock
- Syerra suggested that we have an Elder speak at the closing ceremonies as well, as it is cultural practice to offer words at open and close of events—I agreed
- I have offered that the Elder who agrees to speak will be an honoured guest for the event, so they can attend any of the other talks, workshops, etc., and would be fed as part of this offer.
 - Syerra said that it would be cultural protocol to make sure that Elder is offered food first at any meals, as a point of respect
- We would offer an honorarium for the Elder, and would cover any parking/travel expenses (for Grandmother Jackie, this would likely be a parking pass), as well as a gift offering.
 - Cultural protocols for gifts always involve tobacco, which we can source through Hadiya'dagenhahs. Gifting a blanket is often recommended for Elders, to provide warmth (any blanket, or an Indigenous-made one), or we can purchase beaded earrings from Hadiya'dagenhahs (Sherri doesn't wear them though). I also have a braid of sweetgrass that I would like to add to the gift, as it symbolizes protection.
- Action item: let Syerra know the details of the honorarium so that she can send out an email to Grandmother Jackie with our invitation, by early Friday at the latest.
 - Kiyoko mentioned a starting point of \$250 for funding for this piece—what does the LOC think of \$150 as an honorarium, with the other \$100 allocated to parking passes, food coverage, and a gift?
 - What is an appropriate honorarium amount, in LOC's opinion?
 - Does anyone recommend any Indigenous blanket makers?

Photo Contest – Prize Packs

- Still no submissions, so let's open it up to the LOC—does anyone have any photos they'd like to submit? I'm hoping if folks see other submissions, they would be more inclined to participate.
- Perhaps ad/comms folks can ramp up advertising for the contest, sharing the story on a twice-weekly basis?
- In terms of the prize packs, I have made some progress in sourcing donations. I have been asking local businesses, namely producers of Niagara-specific goodies, if they are inclined to donate and have their business name featured in promotions for the contest, and to have their business cards in the prize packs.
 - We would have six prize packs for the normal categories, plus one special prize for the “People's Choice” winner (who would have also won a prize pack presumably, so this prize would have to be different and slightly higher value—maybe promoting with prizes in mind will encourage participation).
 - So far, Provisions Food Company have been super generous and have donated six bottles of their Peach Passionfruit cocktail syrup and six jars of their wine jam, along with some gorgeous business card/postcards.
 - I have also reached out to Honey Fields, Greaves, White Meadows, Stoke, neob Lavender—White Meadows and neob said they couldn't donate, the others are TBD. I work for Palatine Fruit and Roses, and we have really delicious apricot jam, but I am keeping that as a backup (don't want to be too jam heavy).
 - I am helping to run the Brock Seed Library, so I have made seed balls that I am adding to the gift packs with native pollinator seeds from Kayanase Greenhouse in Six Nations (and my own milkweed).
 - For the regular prize packs, I was envisioning a small gift box with 4-5 Niagara products (jams, syrups, honey, sweets, natural products, seed packs).
- Action item: does anyone have any recommendations for other businesses or products to feature in prize packs? Does anyone have any ideas for the People's Choice award? Do we try and budget to purchase a higher value item?
 - I am hoping to have prize packs put together by the 16th (or at least know what will be in each so that we can advertise prizes and “sponsors”).
 - I will be reaching out to Sarah to put in a request for funding for the packaging materials (I have a source and discount at Prima Wrap, NOTL), and potentially for the People's Choice prize – pending meeting discussion.